

AI or automation?

Sort 1 real task before you choose a tool.

Shift & Lead

THE AI AUTOMATION QUEEN

shiftandlead.com/guides/what-is-ai.html

1 Name 1 real task

Use a task you already do. Do not start with a tool name.

THE TASK

CHECK WHAT IS TRUE

- ☐ It happens often
 ☐ The steps stay mostly the same
 ☐ The input changes from case to case
 ☐ It touches sensitive information

2 Choose the operating path

☐ AUTOMATION

Same trigger, same steps, same finish.

Example: save every new form entry in the CRM.

☐ AI

People describe the same task in different words.

Example: draft a reply from approved service notes.

☐ AI + AUTOMATION

AI creates or sorts. Fixed steps move the approved result.

Example: draft a reply, then create a review task.

☐ HUMAN FIRST

The goal is unclear or a mistake could cause serious harm.

Example: decide a refund, contract term or final price.

3 Design the first safe test

Keep the test small enough to review before it affects a real customer.

INPUT

TRIGGER

AI CREATES OR SORTS

FIXED STEP

PERSON APPROVES

DONE LOOKS LIKE

WORKED EXAMPLE / NEW SALES ENQUIRY

- Trigger:** A website enquiry arrives.
AI: Draft a reply using approved service notes.
Automation: Save the draft in the CRM and create a review task.
Person: Check the promise, price and next step. Then send.
Finished: The prospect gets a checked reply and the next action is recorded.

THE RULE

Use AI to produce options. Use automation to move approved work. Keep a person responsible for anything that affects clients, money, access, legal commitments or reputation.